



CANDIDATE – PLEASE NOTE!

PRINT your name on the line below and return this booklet with your answer sheet. Failure to do so may result in disqualification.

TEST CODE **01218010**

JANUARY 2017

FORM TP 2017007

C A R I B B E A N E X A M I N A T I O N S C O U N C I L
CARIBBEAN SECONDARY EDUCATION CERTIFICATE®
EXAMINATION

ENGLISH A

Paper 01 – General Proficiency

1 hour 30 minutes

03 JANUARY 2017 (p.m.)

READ THE FOLLOWING INSTRUCTIONS CAREFULLY.

1. This test consists of 60 items. You will have 1 hour and 30 minutes to answer them.
2. In addition to this test booklet, you should have an answer sheet.
3. Each item in this test has four suggested answers lettered (A), (B), (C), (D). Read each item you are about to answer and decide which choice is best.
4. On your answer sheet, find the number which corresponds to the item and shade the space having the same letter as the answer you have chosen. Look at the sample item below.

Sample Item

Choose the word that BEST completes the sentence.

Someone who is suffering from influenza needs to be isolated as the disease is _____.

- (A) lasting
- (B) serious
- (C) contagious
- (D) destructive

Sample Answer



The best answer to this item is “contagious,” so (C) has been shaded.

5. If you want to change your answer, erase it completely before you fill in your new choice.
6. When you are told to begin, turn the page and work as quickly and as carefully as you can. If you cannot answer an item, go on to the next one. You may return to that item later.

DO NOT TURN THIS PAGE UNTIL YOU ARE TOLD TO DO SO.

Instructions: Each sentence in this section has ONE underlined word. Choose the word that is closest to OPPOSITE in meaning to the underlined word.

1. The manager decided to inform the staff about all complaints received from customers.
 - (A) requests
 - (B) demands
 - (C) suggestions
 - (D) compliments

2. There was a decline in airplane travel after the September 11, 2001 attacks.
 - (A) increase
 - (B) upheaval
 - (C) decrease
 - (D) fluctuation

3. In these difficult economic times, many organizations retrench workers only when absolutely necessary.
 - (A) demote
 - (B) employ
 - (C) dismiss
 - (D) promote

4. While the employers approved of his work habits, they objected to his radical views.
 - (A) capitalist
 - (B) informed
 - (C) fashionable
 - (D) conventional

5. Many teenagers and even some parents do not agree with the amount of restrictiveness in today's society.
 - (A) strife
 - (B) cruelty
 - (C) permissiveness
 - (D) competitiveness

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Items 6–10

Instructions: Each sentence in this section is followed by four sentences, A, B, C and D. Choose the sentence NEAREST in meaning to the original sentence. Read all four sentences before you choose your answer.

6. The lion, which had fallen ill, was lying in his den famished and upon the point of death.
- (A) The famous lion lying in his den was sick and on the point of death.
 - (B) As a result of being starved, the lion collapsed in his den, sick and near death.
 - (C) The famished lion, on the point of death, had fallen ill while lying in his den.
 - (D) The sick lion was lying in his den, extremely hungry and on the point of death.
7. John told his parents in no uncertain terms that he was going to university as soon as he left school.
- (A) John boasted to his parents that he was going to university as soon as he left school.
 - (B) John told his parents that they should permit him to go to university after he left school.
 - (C) John made it quite clear to his parents that when he left school he would go to university immediately.
 - (D) John's parents were told that it was obviously his desire to attend university immediately after leaving school.
8. I cannot understand why you have done this since you tell me that Mark means a lot to you.
- (A) Since Mark means a lot to you, the reason for your action is puzzling to me.
 - (B) Since you tell me that Mark means a lot to you, he cannot understand why you have done this.
 - (C) You tell me that although Mark means a lot to you, you did this.
 - (D) Mark cannot mean a lot to you or else I know you would not have done this.
9. Realizing that her suitcase was left on the bus, the woman desperately tried to attract the conductor's attention.
- (A) When the desperate woman noticed that she was leaving the bus without her suitcase, she tried to attract the conductor's attention.
 - (B) When the woman became aware that she had left her suitcase, she tried her best to attract the attention of the bus conductor.
 - (C) The woman made all attempts to attract the conductor's attention to the suitcase which she had left on the bus.
 - (D) The conductor's attention was attracted by the woman who in desperation, had forgotten her suitcase on the bus.
10. Much is being done to develop tourism in our country by providing good hotel accommodation and facilities.
- (A) It is important to provide good hotel accommodation and facilities for tourists.
 - (B) Good hotel accommodation and facilities are crucial if we want to develop tourism.
 - (C) We are doing a great deal to boost tourism by providing good hotel accommodation and facilities.
 - (D) If we do not provide good hotel accommodation and facilities, tourists will not come to our country.



Items 11–15

Instructions: Select the option, A, B, C or D, that BEST describes EACH of the sentences and mark your choice on the answer sheet.

- (A) The sentence is acceptable as it stands.
 - (B) The sentence contains a cliché or misused metaphor.
 - (C) The sentence is incorrect grammatically or faulty in diction.
 - (D) The sentence is too wordy, is repetitive or contains redundancies.
-
- 11. There are many who have not considered the need to abstain from alcohol, but abandoning drink for sobriety is truly the only option for one who wishes to engage in healthy lifestyle practices.
 - 12. He wanted to beg for his old job, but that ship had sailed, and he had to simply play the hand that was dealt him.
 - 13. To attract more business, the store offered transportation at no expense to the customer.
 - 14. If I were the captain of the West Indies cricket team, I will attack the batsmen with my fast bowlers immediately after the luncheon interval.
 - 15. From the examination results, it was quite clear that Joanne's work was not up to mark and so she missed the boat.

Items 16–20

Instructions: Some of the following sentences are unacceptable because of inappropriate grammar, idiom or vocabulary. Some sentences are acceptable as they stand. No sentence contains more than one inappropriate element.

Select the ONE underlined part that you feel is inappropriate and choose the corresponding letter, A, B or C. If the sentence is acceptable as it stands, choose D. Mark your choice on the answer sheet.

16. Overcome by fear, I ran passed my home without realizing that I had done so. No error
(A) (B) (C) (D)
17. In *A House for Mr Biswas*, Naipaul shows that how a man may struggle against great odds to
(A) (B)
achieve those things that he most desires. No error
(C) (D)
18. I believe that if his attitude improves his general performance will also improve. No error
(A) (B) (C) (D)
19. Pray, good deeds and living well with one's neighbours are essential to spiritual health.
(A) (B) (C)
No error
(D)
20. The athletes with the worst performances claim never to have used the dangerous drugs found on
(A) (B) (C)
their possession. No error
(D)



Items 21–30

Instructions: Read the following poem carefully and then answer Items 21–30 on the basis of what is stated or implied.

A Bad Day

I cannot smile today
nor be pleasant today
I do not like people today
and particularly hate children today
5 today I am sad
today I am mad
at everybody and everything
I hurt today
I can't love today
10 nor see beauty
today
I wish the wind away
No, I can't be happy today
I looked down the future today
15 and began to die today.

Cynthia Wilson, "A Bad Day".

Hibiscus Bears A Blue Flower - Poems and Musings,

Cynthia Wilson, 2004, p.64.

21. Which of the following is NOT true of the poet today?

- (A) She cannot smile.
- (B) She cannot be sad today.
- (C) She does not love children.
- (D) She cannot see beauty in anything.

23. The word "particularly" (line 4) is NEAREST in meaning to

- (A) rarely
- (B) sincerely
- (C) especially
- (D) truthfully

22. Which of the following words BEST describes the poet's mood?

- (A) Jovial
- (B) Anxious
- (C) Reflective
- (D) Melancholic

24. Which of the following is an example of alliteration?

- (A) "cannot smile today" (line 1)
- (B) "can't love today" (line 9)
- (C) "wish the wind away" (line 12)
- (D) "began to die today" (line 15)

25. The poet repeats the word "today" for
- (A) balance
 - (B) emphasis
 - (C) consistency
 - (D) enhancement
26. "I looked down the future today" (line 14) is an example of
- (A) simile
 - (B) metaphor
 - (C) onomatopoeia
 - (D) apostrophe
27. The words "nor see beauty" (line 10) mean that the poet cannot
- (A) see nature
 - (B) see children
 - (C) tolerate people
 - (D) appreciate anything
28. The mood of the poem can BEST be described as
- (A) peaceful
 - (B) sarcastic
 - (C) depressing
 - (D) apprehensive
29. The poet "began to die" (line 15) probably because
- (A) the weather was gloomy
 - (B) she could not control her anger
 - (C) future events did not look promising
 - (D) there were too many people around her
30. The poet's intention is to
- (A) inform us of her activities
 - (B) express her hatred of people
 - (C) show us her dislike of children
 - (D) tell us of her unhappy condition



Items 31–38

Instructions: Read the following passage carefully and then answer Items 31–38 on the basis of what is stated or implied.

The Sisters

Over the years, Marta had sent many warm and friendly messages to Elana, inviting her to visit Ilora and assuring her that she'd always be welcome. But her prodigal sister never replied. From time to time, however, traders brought news that Elana's marriage to Iyako had been blessed with two sets of twins, that Iyako had succeeded his father as ruler of the Kingdom of Horses, and that their marriage was a stormy one. For a long time there was no further news until one day, a traveller told Queen Marta that Iyako had been thrown by a wild horse and had broken his back, that Elana had lost both her beauty and her mind and, after shouting night and day that the Kingdom of Wild Horses was an accursed one, she had escaped from keepers. "They searched high and low for her, but she had vanished without a trace," the traveller said, shaking his head sadly.

- 10 The Queen immediately summoned Leha and ordered her to send search parties to all of the countries bordering on the Kingdom of Wild Horses.

"Go to the ends of the earth if you have to, but bring my sister back to Ilora. Whoever finds her will be amply rewarded," Queen Marta said to the trackers, traders and interpreters whom Leha had recruited. But after years of futile searching, the search parties returned one by one and reported that they had found no trace of Elana.

"It's as if your sister has vanished from the face of the earth," Leha said. "I hear you," Queen Marta said "and yet I feel in my bones that she's still alive."

Leha had led one of the search parties, and when she returned her hair was streaked with grey and age had mapped her rough-hewn face with lines as delicate as spider webs.

- 20 The first time that Leha stepped into the Audience Room to report about her travels to distant places in search of Elana, she was both surprised and pleased to see how Queen Marta had aged. When their eyes made four, the smiling Leha said to herself, "It's as if her face had beaten very gently against the years," for she could see quite clearly how time had changed what was once an ugly countenance into a beautiful one. When a shaft of sunlight touched the cloud of white hair on the Queen's head, it became luminous, and a welcoming smile lighting up her dark face lifted Leha's spirits and made her heart sing. And somehow, all the hardships she had endured travelling across parched savannahs, through densely wooded valleys, over mountains and down turbulent rivers, were forgotten.

Jan Carew, The Sister and Manco's Stories, Macmillan, 2003, pp. 46–47.

31. The style of writing in this extract can BEST be described as
- (A) factual
 - (B) narrative
 - (C) descriptive
 - (D) argumentative
32. What do the words, "their marriage was a stormy one" (lines 4–5) imply?
- (A) They married on a stormy day.
 - (B) There were happy times in the marriage.
 - (C) The couple was not sure of the marriage.
 - (D) The marriage was filled with disagreements.
33. The instruction "Go to the ends of the earth" (line 12) implies that they should search
- (A) every accessible land
 - (B) the Kingdom of Wild Horses
 - (C) over mountains and down rivers
 - (D) through densely wooded valleys
34. The literary device used in the phrase "as delicate as spider webs" (line 19) is a
- (A) pun
 - (B) simile
 - (C) metaphor
 - (D) hyperbole
35. The writer implies that Leha was
- (A) the leader of the queen's army
 - (B) a household servant
 - (C) Marta's sister
 - (D) a traveller
36. Which of the following is an example of contrast?
- (A) She "had lost both her beauty and her mind" (line 6).
 - (B) "she had vanished without a trace" (line 8).
 - (C) "her hair was streaked with grey" (line 18).
 - (D) "lighting up her dark face" (line 25).
37. "The cloud of white hair" (line 24) is an example of
- (A) litotes
 - (B) metaphor
 - (C) oxymoron
 - (D) personification
38. The concluding sentence of the extract suggests that
- (A) they had forgotten all about Elana
 - (B) they had given up the search for Elana
 - (C) Leha would be willing to continue the search
 - (D) the problems which Leha had encountered in the search were forgotten

Items 39–47

Instructions: Read the following extract carefully and then answer Items 39–47 on the basis of what is stated or implied.

When the traditional family unit is discussed, it is usually in terms of the external social changes that are threatening its existence as an institution. Little thought is given to the internal problems of normal homes. The central problem for most family members is, of course, how to get along with each other. This internal matter is not without its external implications; for only
5 where there are orderly and peaceful families can there be an orderly and peaceful society.

Of all the social changes that have affected the family in recent years, by far the most significant has been the increase in the number of mothers of school-age children who have taken outside employment. In Canada, some 75 per cent of women in this category now have full-time or part-time jobs. For the most part, economic imperatives have left women no choice but to
10 work for money. An income sufficient to maintain an average family style took one Canadian 48 hours a week to earn in the 1950s. It takes two people 65 to 75 hours a week to earn that income today.

The conflicts between work and family life and scarcity of time to devote to children have taken a personal toll on women in the form of stress and depression. Obviously, individuals under
15 stress are harder to deal with than those who are not, so the tensions of work are carried over into tensions in mother–child relationships. Men, too, report feeling ‘stressed out’ and squeezed between work and family obligations. Males raised in the tradition of mothers doing everything in the home are inclined to be lax in doing housework and awkward in the unaccustomed role of actively nurturing children. But if a two-income family is to run smoothly and fairly, the household
20 workload must be shared.

Another profound change in family relationships lies in the relatively high incidence of divorce and marital separations in Western society. The fact that so many couples feel they must go their separate ways illustrates just how difficult it is for people to live together satisfactorily at the best of times.

39. According to paragraph 1 (lines 1–5), which of the following results from conflict between family members?

- (A) Disorder in societies
- (B) Anxious parents and children
- (C) Disruptive behaviour in homes
- (D) High levels of tension between parents

40. According to the extract, all of the following threaten the existence of the family EXCEPT

- (A) the high divorce rate in western society
- (B) conflicts between employers and working parents
- (C) problems family members experience in getting along
- (D) the increase in the number of mothers of school-age children working outside of the home

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41. The word that is closest in meaning to “imperatives” (line 9) is
- (A) demands
 - (B) matters
 - (C) concerns
 - (D) guidelines
42. In paragraph 2 (lines 6–12), the writer compares income in the 1950s to income today to show that
- (A) people today work longer hours for the same pay as in the 1950s
 - (B) people earned more in the 1950s than today
 - (C) people today do not work as hard as people in the 1950s
 - (D) a single income cannot adequately support an average family
43. According to the writer in paragraph 3 (lines 13–20), tensions in mother–child relationships can occur because
- I. mothers are under stress
 - II. parents and children are under stress
 - III. mothers are depressed and hard to deal with
- (A) I only
 - (B) II only
 - (C) I and III only
 - (D) II and III only
44. The writer’s main purpose is to
- (A) focus on the problems experienced by men
 - (B) reveal the problems experienced by men, women and children
 - (C) highlight some of the internal problems threatening the family
 - (D) show that single income families function better than two-income families
45. The writer’s main intention in lines 15–20 is to show that
- (A) men in two-income households never help in the home
 - (B) two-income households always experience stress
 - (C) children in two-income households are neglected
 - (D) sharing of the household workload can help a two-income family to run smoothly
46. Couples feel they must “go their separate ways” (lines 22–23) because of
- (A) high divorce rates
 - (B) problems with existing agreeably
 - (C) difficulty with Western societies
 - (D) changes in relations in good times
47. The tone of the passage may be best described as
- (A) analytical
 - (B) mocking
 - (C) indignant
 - (D) complaining



Items 48–54

Instructions: Read the following extract carefully and then answer Items 48–54 on the basis of what is stated or implied.

He's the Man

Ladies and Gentlemen, I present to you the candidate for Dimsville. He is the man who will make all your dreams come true. He is the man who will fulfil all your wishes. He is the man who will stand by you through thick and thin. Our opponents say that he comes from a foreign country and he is not one of you. I must thank them for their kind comments because that is
5 just what you need – his exposure to a developed world. He is equipped with the best ideas that will create opportunities for you.

Don't you need steady jobs? And how about a school like that which the other areas have? Yes, my friends. You need to live like valued citizens. Not like oppressed slaves in endless destitution.

Your lives are not a journey into the Promised Land. You wander in a vast wilderness where hostile
10 forces of humanity hound you with relentless cruelty. Your daily bread is sickness and worry, hunger and disease. Your hovels are dens of misery filled with empty hopes and despair. Have you considered the future of the children?

Look at this man; the man who will make your dreams come true; the man who will give you your wishes; the man who cares enough to come to your village.

48. This speech was MOST likely given at a
- (A) board meeting
 - (B) business meeting
 - (C) political meeting
 - (D) church meeting
49. In the extract, the writer addresses the audience as “you” in order to
- (A) present himself to the audience
 - (B) distance himself from the audience
 - (C) accuse the audience of failing in their duty
 - (D) make the audience feel he cares about them
50. The speaker suggests that because the candidate “comes from a foreign country” (lines 3–4) he will
- (A) not appreciate them
 - (B) leave them at anytime
 - (C) be an advantage to them
 - (D) not represent them well
51. When the speaker says “You need to live like valued citizens” (line 8), he attempts to
- (A) make the villagers feel good
 - (B) condemn the way the villagers live
 - (C) change the villagers’ way of life
 - (D) make the villagers feel they are treated well

52. The name Dimsville is suitable for the village because

- (A) it is an important name
- (B) there is no electricity in the village
- (C) it is named after someone who used to live there
- (D) the villagers feel hopeless because they lack basic amenities

53. In paragraph 1, the speaker repeats the words "He is the man" because he wants to

- (A) present the candidate as a superman
- (B) emphasize the power the candidate possesses
- (C) inform the villagers that they need a man and not a woman to represent them
- (D) impress upon the audience that he is offering them the best person for the job

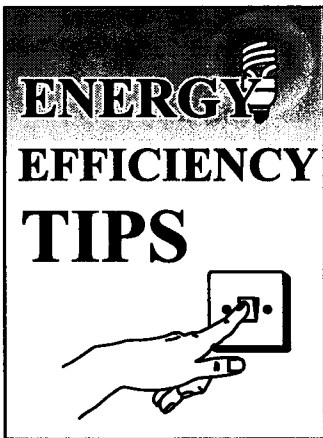
54. Which of the following devices is NOT used in the speech?

- (A) Pun
- (B) Metaphor
- (C) Repetition
- (D) Rhetorical question



Items 55–60

Instructions: Read the following advertisement carefully and then answer Items 55–60 on the basis of what is stated or implied.



**ENERGY
EFFICIENCY
TIPS**

1. Keep fixtures and bulbs clean. Dirt can absorb as much as 50% of light.
2. Turn off the lights when leaving a room even if it's only for a few minutes. It's just a myth that it takes more energy to turn a light on than to leave it on.
3. Use motion sensors for outdoor lights. They're a good security measure that doesn't waste energy.
4. Use lower wattage bulbs; your lights may be brighter than you need.
5. Purchase lamps with dimmer switches, as you can lower the settings when less light is required.
6. Place floor or table lamps in a corner. This allows light to reflect from the walls, making the room brighter without turning on more lights.
7. Use fluorescent lights instead of incandescent lights. Compact fluorescent lights use up to 75% less energy than incandescent lights, for the same amount of light and last up to ten times longer.

55. The main purpose of this advertisement is to
- (A) sell light bulbs
(B) promote lighting in the home
(C) encourage better energy use
(D) highlight energy use in the home
56. Which of the following is the BEST meaning of the word “absorb” as used in Tip 1 of the advertisement?
- (A) Use up
(B) Soak up
(C) Take in
(D) Swallow up
57. Which of the following practices is recommended?
- (A) Turning off all lights for a minute
(B) Turning off the lights for short periods
(C) Keeping the lights on when leaving a room
(D) Turning off the lights when leaving a room
58. The advertisement emphasizes that motion sensors are important because they
- (A) are efficient and provide security
(B) are cheaper and brighter
(C) do not waste energy
(D) use energy indoors
59. Which of the following statements is NOT made in the advertisement?
- (A) Low wattage bulbs use less energy.
(B) Lamps placed on the floor are better for energy efficiency.
(C) Not all light bulbs are energy efficient.
(D) Compact fluorescent lights are energy efficient.
60. The information in the advertisement would be MOST useful to
- (A) contractors
(B) electricians
(C) householders
(D) the light company

END OF TEST

IF YOU FINISH BEFORE TIME IS CALLED, CHECK YOUR WORK ON THIS TEST.